Little Fox Readers

Level 5

JOURNEY to the WEST 62

The Goldfish in the Basket



Little Fox



Wukong landed on Mount Potalaka. A young man was meditating in the garden.

"Where's Guanyin?" asked the monkey.

"She's making a basket," said the man. He glanced up at the monkey. "It's good to see you again, Wukong."

Wukong was puzzled. "How do you know my name?"



“Don’t you recognize me?” said the man.

Wukong stared for a moment and then gasped. “You’re Red Boy! You look like a kind spirit now.”

“Yes,” said Red Boy. “I’m not an evil demon anymore. And I have you to thank for that. You brought Guanyin to me. She has taught me all about Buddhism, and now I’m very happy.”



“You’re welcome,” said Wukong. “You and I have a lot in common. We were both evil, causing all sorts of problems. Now we’re both Buddhists.”

Guanyin came over holding a basket. “Hello, Wukong,” said the bodhisattva. “I knew you would come here today. I’ve been working on this basket all morning.”

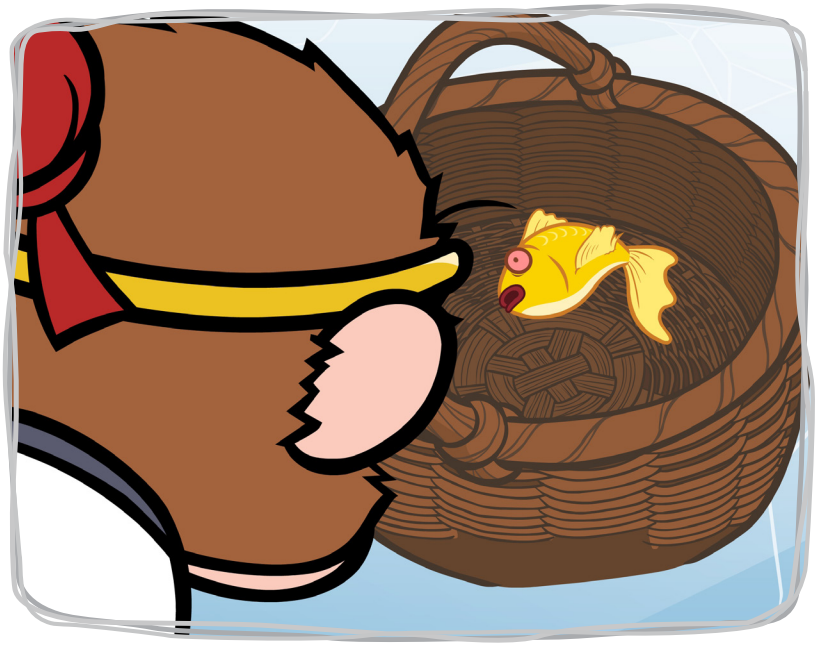
A look of confusion spread across



the monkey's face. "That's a nice basket, Bodhisattva. But what is it for?"

"This basket has magical powers," said Guanyin. "I will catch the demon with it. Let's go."

Wukong returned to the river with Guanyin. The bodhisattva used a rope to lower the basket into the river. She recited a spell and then waited. After a moment she



pulled the basket out of the water.

Wukong looked in the basket. A small goldfish was flopping around in it.

The monkey laughed. “I guess you need to try again, Bodhisattva. That’s not the demon.”

“This is my goldfish,” said Guanyin. “It usually lives in my lotus pond. The pond is near my garden, where I teach my students.



After years of listening to my lessons, the fish became a spirit. It escaped to Earth a few days ago. I had been wondering where it was."

"A few days ago," repeated Wukong. "That means it's been on Earth for a few years."

"Correct," said Guanyin. "The Tang Monk is safe now. You may go free him



and continue your journey to the Western Paradise."

Guanyin flew off, and Wukong swam down to the palace. Now that the goldfish was gone, so was its magic. The monkey smashed the rocks with his iron bar and went inside.

"Master, I'm here!" he cried. He got the monk out of the box and carried him out of



the river.

By now all the villagers had heard that Wukong had saved Chen's son. When the travelers returned, the villagers cheered.

"Please stay in our village!" said a man.

"Yes," said an old woman. "There's no rush to leave. Stay for as long as you like."

"Thank you," said the Tang Monk. "But we can stay only one more night, to rest. In



the morning we must leave. We still have far to travel."

The villagers held a feast for the travelers that evening. By the time everyone went to sleep, it was late.

The next morning the travelers woke to the sound of chopping.

"What's going on?" asked the Tang Monk.



They went to the river and found a very busy scene. Several men were chopping down trees. Other people carried tools.

“We’re building a boat for you!” said a smiling man.

“Thank you,” said the monk.

He and his companions sat down by the water to wait. Suddenly there was a rumble, and waves splashed onto the shore.

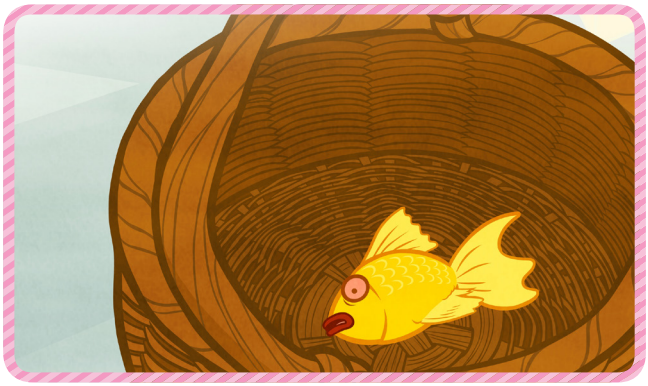


Everyone stared in fear as a large creature rose from the waves.

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